

1. What famous 1920s novel with Nick Carraway as narrator does this passage come from?

"The only completely stationary object in the room was an enormous couch on which two young women were buoyed up as though upon an anchored balloon. They were both in white and their dresses were rippling and fluttering as if they had just been blown back in after a short flight around the house...Then there was a boom as Tom Buchanan shut the rear windows and the caught wind died out about the room and the curtains and the rugs and the two young women ballooned slowly to the floor."

The Great Gatsby

2. What famous novel about Nick Adams has this scene with reminders of the Great War?

"Nick gets off a train with his few belongings at the remnants of the old town of Seney. The landscape is burned. He watches the trout in a nearby river for a long time, and the experience brings back old feelings."

In Our Time

3. Which novel has this hero who is forever watching women?

"Selden had never seen her more radiant. Her vivid head...made her more conspicuous than in a ball-room...she regained the girlish smoothness, the purity of tint, that she was beginning to lose after eleven years of late hours and indefatigable dancing. Was it really eleven years, Selden found himself wondering, and had she indeed reached the nine-and-twentieth birthday with which her rivals credited her?"

The House of Mirth

4. Which novel of ideas features people together to recover their health?

"They had reached the second floor, when Hans Castorp suddenly stopped... mesmerized by a perfectly ghastly noise he heard coming...- not a loud noise, but so decidedly repulsive that Hans Castorp grimaced....It was a cough, apparently - a man's cough, but a cough unlike any that Hans Castorp had ever heard; a cough [...] which didn't come in spasms, but sounded as if someone was stirring feebly in a terrible mush of decomposing organic material."

The Magic Mountain

5. What novel opens Proust's many volumed novel about memory, class and love?

"And as soon as I had recognized the taste of the piece of madeleine soaked in her decoction of lime-blossom which my aunt used to give me...the whole of Combray and its surroundings, taking shape and solidity, sprang into being, town and gardens alike, from my cup of tea."

Swann's Way

6. What famous Greek epic is this passage from? It deals with a wife greeting her husband after a long absence

"She sat a long time in silence, and her heart was wondering. Sometimes she would look at him, with her eyes full upon him, and again would fail to know him in the foul clothing he wore. Telemachos spoke to her....why do you withdraw so from my father, and do not sit beside him and ask him questions and find out about him?"

The Odyssey of Homer

7. In what famous existentialist novel does this opening passage occur?

"Maman died today. Or yesterday maybe, I don't know. I got a telegram from the home:

Mother deceased. Funeral tomorrow. Faithfully yours. That doesn't mean anything. Maybe it was yesterday."

The Stranger

8. In which highly experimental novel of the 20s does this scene occur between brother and sister?

"'Hello, Benjy.' Caddy said. She opened the gate and came in and stooped down. Caddy smelled like leaves.... 'Did you come to meet Caddy.' she said, rubbing my hands. 'What is it. What are you trying to tell Caddy.' Caddy smelled like trees and like when she says we were asleep."

The Sound and the Fury

9. What famous novel has a title which has become a kind of catch phrase for a dead-end situation?

"Clevinger really thought he was right, but Yossarian had proof, because strangers he didn't know shot at him with cannons every time he flew up into the air to drop bombs on them, and it wasn't funny at all. And if that wasn't funny, there were lots of things that weren't even funnier."

Catch 22

10. In which 19th century novel, does a heroine say the following of her love?

". . . he's more myself than I am. Whatever our souls are made of, his and mine are the same, and Linton's is as different as a moonbeam from lightning, or frost from fire."

Wuthering Heights



1. "It is a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune must be in want of a wife." Everyone knows this opening line to what is arguably Jane Austen's most famous novel, 'Pride and Prejudice,' the love story between the independent Elizabeth and the brooding Darcy. However, what is the start of the next line, considerably less noted?

However little known the feelings or views of such a man may be on his first entering a neighbourhood...

2. 'A Tale of Two Cities' is Dickens at his best. Virtually everyone can tell you that "It was the best of times, it was the worst of times..." and the sentence goes on in this manner - antithesis, or naming pairs of opposites. However, what is the next line?

There were a king with a large jaw and a queen with a plain face, on the throne of England

3. Jo March, the little woman that so many girls want to be, says the first line of Louisa May Alcott's novel, 'Little Woman.' The line is "Christmas won't be Christmas without any presents." My question is: Who marries the character that states the next line? ("It's so dreadful to be poor.")

Mr. Brooke

4. 'The Scarlet Letter' opens with a line that aptly sets the mood for the rest of the book. The bleak descriptions give us a clear picture of the grim setting. The line reads, "A throng of bearded men, in sad-coloured garments and gray steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods, and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes." The next line speaks of two places that, while they might not want to have them, are necessary. What are these two locations?

cemetery, prison

5. Ah, Joyce. Joyce's 'Ulysses' was one of the hardest books that I ever read, but it was worth the effort. The first line is "Stately, plump Buck Mulligan came from the stairhead, bearing a bowl of lather on which a mirror and a razor lay crossed." What is the next line?

A yellow dressing gown, ungirdled, was sustained gently-behind him by the mild morning air.

6. When Hamlet says, "To be, or not to be; that is the question," does he know that he is saying what is arguably the most famous quote of all time?. While we may never know what Shakespeare truly intended there, the opening of this fascinating study of the human mind that we call 'Hamlet, Prince of Denmark' is much simpler. The first line involves Bernardo calling "Who's there?" Who answers him with the second line?

Francisco

7. "Some years ago- never mind how long precisely- having little or no money in my purse, and nothing particular to interest me on shore, I thought I would sail about a little and see the watery part of the world." This is the second line of a book with a much more famous first line. What is the first line that accompanies this quote?

Call me Ishmael.

8. Harper Lee's only novel turned her into a sensation. "When he was nearly thirteen, my brother Jem got his arm badly broken at the elbow." In the second line, he was said to be afraid of never being able to play a certain sport again. What sport was it?

Football

9. Kate Chopin's short story, "A Shameful Affair" begins with these words: "Mildred Orme, seated in the snuggest corner of the big front porch of the Kraummer farmhouse, was as content as a girl need hope to be." What was the next line?

This was no such farm as one reads about in humorous fiction.

10. One more, from O. Henry's "The Gift of the Magi," the classic tale of Della and Jim each sacrificing their favorite possessions for the other, only to find that the other had bought

something to enhance what had been sacrificed. "One dollar and eighty-seven cents." What comes next?

That was all.

1. "We caught fish and talked, and we took a swim now and then to keep off sleepiness. It was kind of solemn, drifting down the big, still river, laying on our backs, looking up at the stars, and we didn't ever feel like talking loud, and it warn't often that we laughed - only a little kind of a low chuckle." Who speaks these words?

The correct answer was **Huckleberry Finn**

This is from chapter 12 of Mark Twain's "Huckleberry Finn" which features Huck and Jim. The major theme of this book is turning one's back on the deceit and shallowness of civilisation and getting back to what is real and true.

2. "When I look back on my childhood I wonder how I survived it all. It was, of course, a miserable childhood: the happy childhood is hardly worth your while. Worse than the ordinary miserable childhood is the miserable Irish childhood, and worse yet is the miserable Irish Catholic childhood." From which work is this quote?

The correct answer was **Angela's Ashes**

"Angela's Ashes" is the book by Irish writer Frank McCourt and spans life from his childhood in Ireland to that of his life in America. I intensely dislike the orchestrated ugliness of this book, particularly its ending, and feel it detracts from the entire work.

3. "A lie gets half way around the world before the truth has a chance to get its pants on." Who said this?

Your Answer: **Winston Churchill**

Sir Winston Churchill, statesman, politician, orator, leader of the United Kingdom through its darkest hours, won the Nobel Prize for literature in

1953 for his many writings, which included a six volume set titled "The Second World War". His own life story makes remarkable reading.

4. "I've got to get some seeds. I've got to get some seeds, right away. Nothing's planted. I don't have a thing in the ground."
From which work is this quote?

The correct answer was **Death of A Salesman**

Spoken by Willy Loman in Act Two of "Death Of A Salesman" by Arthur Miller, this work is the agonising story of one man's struggle for conception of self and what he sees as the successful life, contrasted against what is his actuality.

5. "There is only now, and if two days is your life, then everything in it will be in proportion. This is how you live a life in two days. And if you stop complaining and asking for what you will never get, you will have a good life." From which work is this quote?

The correct answer was **For Whom The Bell Tolls**

"For Whom the Bell Tolls" by Ernest Hemingway is the story of a young American in the International Brigades during the Spanish Civil War. These words are spoken by the main character, Robert Jordan, in chapter thirteen, after he and Maria have made love in the heather. Dear me, how prickly.

6. "I pass the lighted windows of a shop where perfume is sold. The window is filled with pieces of broken glass, tiny transparent bottles in delicate colours, like bits of a shattered rainbow. Then all at once my sister touches my shoulder.. Oh Laura, Laura, I tried to leave you behind me, but I am more faithful than I intended to be!...I speak to the nearest stranger, anything that can blow your candles out!...Blow out your candles, Laura - and so goodbye." From which work is this quote?

The correct answer was **The Glass Menagerie**

This work by Tennessee Williams tells of a family trapped in destructive behaviour patterns. The quote is from Tom, many years later, long after he has left the home of his youth, turning his back on them all.

7. "If it wasn't for the mist we could see your home across the bay...You always have a green light that burns all night at the end of your dock." From which work is this quote?

The correct answer was **The Great Gatsby**

The main theme in "The Great Gatsby" by F. Scott Fitzgerald is that which runs through many of the mighty American novels - that of the disillusionment of the great American Dream. For Gatsby, in this novel, Daisy represents this dream and its disillusionment.

8. "I see you stand like greyhounds in the slips, Straining upon the start. The games afoot: Follow your spirit; and upon this charge, Cry 'God for Harry! England and Saint George!'" From which work is this quote?

The correct answer was **Henry V**

This stirring speech is from Shakespeare's Henry V, Act 3, Scene I. Another jolly battle and more blood and guts. Tallyho, boys!

9. "To lose one parent, Mr Worthing, may be regarded as a misfortune; to lose both looks like carelessness." From which work is this quote?

The correct answer was **The Importance of Being Earnest**

Written by the brilliant Oscar Wilde, these words are spoken by Lady Bracknell in Act One of "The Importance of Being Earnest". This amusing and clever play deals with several characters maintaining false identities to avoid all the rigid social and moral expectations of that time in Victorian England. And didn't poor old Oscar find that out big time.

10. "What worries me, Billy," she said - I could hear the change in her voice - "is how your mother is going to take this." From which work is this quote?

"One Flew Over the Cuckoo's Nest" by Ken Kesey is a powerful novel about the individual's struggle against the authority and repression and conformity that society demands - symbolised in the book by one man's struggle against the nurse in control of an insane asylum.

